TYLER M. RANSOM Curriculum Vitae

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Education

2015	Ph.D. in Economics, Duke University
	Dissertation: Dynamic Models of Human Capital Accumulation.
	Committee: Peter Arcidiacono (chair), Patrick Bayer, V. Joseph Hotz, Arnaud Maurel
2010	M.A. in Economics, Duke University
2009	B.A. in Economics (Magna Cum Laude), Brigham Young University

Employment

2022–	Associate Professor of Economics (with tenure), University of Oklahoma
2017–2022	Assistant Professor of Economics, University of Oklahoma
2015–2017	Postdoctoral Associate, Social Science Research Institute, Duke University

Affiliations

2023–	Research Fellow, IZA@LISER
2017–2023	Research Affiliate, IZA@LISER (formerly Institute for the Study of Labor, IZA)
2022–	Fellow, Global Labor Organization (GLO)

Editorial Responsibilities

2026–	Coeditor, *Economics of Education Review*
2025	Associate Editor, *Economics of Education Review*
2022–	Associate Editor, *Annals of Economics and Statistics*

Research Fields

Primary:	Labor Economics, Economics of Education
Secondary:	Urban, Health, Industrial Organization, Applied Econometrics

Published & Forthcoming Papers

2026	17.	"New Developments in Understanding Why People Do Not Move", *Reaching Regions*, 2026.
2025	16.	"College Attrition and the Dynamics of Information Revelation" (with Peter Arcidiacono, Esteban Aucejo, and Arnaud Maurel), *Journal of Political Economy*, 133 (1): 53–110.

2024 15. "Divergent: The Time Path of Legacy and Athlete Admissions at Harvard" (with Peter Arcidiacono and Josh Kinsler), *Journal of Human Resources*, 59 (3): 653–683. **(Lead article)**

2023 14. "What the Students for Fair Admissions Cases Reveal About Racial Preferences" (with Peter Arcidiacono and Josh Kinsler), *Journal of Political Economy Microeconomics*, 1 (4): 615–668. **(Lead article)**

13. "Instrumental Variables Estimation: Assumptions, Pitfalls, and Guidelines" (with Nicolas Bastardoz, Michael Matthews, Gwendolin Sajons, Tom Kelemen, and Samuel Matthews), *The Leadership Quarterly*, 34 (1): 101673.

2022 12. "Understanding Migration Aversion Using Elicited Expectations and Counterfactuals" (with Gizem Koşar and Wilbert van der Klaauw), *Journal of Econometrics*, 231 (1): 123–147.

11. "Recruit to Reject? Harvard and African American Applicants" (with Peter Arcidiacono and Josh Kinsler), *Economics of Education Review*, Volume 88: 102255.

10. "Asian American Discrimination in Harvard Admissions" (with Peter Arcidiacono and Josh Kinsler), *European Economic Review*, Volume 144, Article 104079.

9. "Labor Market Frictions and Moving Costs of the Employed and Unemployed," *Journal of Human Resources*, 57 (S): S137–S166.

8. "Legacy and Athlete Preferences at Harvard" (with Peter Arcidiacono and Josh Kinsler), *Journal of Labor Economics*, 40 (1): 133–156.

2021 7. "Changes across Cohorts in Wage Returns to Schooling and Early Work Experiences" (with Jared Ashworth, V. Joseph Hotz and Arnaud Maurel), *Journal of Labor Economics*, 39 (4): 931–964.

6. "Selective Migration, Occupational Choice, and the Wage Returns to College Majors," *Annals of Economics & Statistics*, No. 142: 45–110.

5. "Learning during the COVID-19 pandemic: It is not who you teach, but how you teach" (with George Orlov, Douglas McKee, James Berry, Austin Boyle, Thomas J. DiCiccio, Alex Rees-Jones, and Jörg Stoye), *Economics Letters*, 202: 109812. **(Lead article)**

4. "Do Foreigners Crowd Natives out of STEM Degrees and Occupations? Evidence from the U.S. Immigration Act of 1990" (with John V. Winters), *ILR Review*, 74 (2): 321–351.

2020 3. "Affirmative Action, Transparency, and the *SFFA v. Harvard Case*" (with Peter Arcidiacono and Josh Kinsler), *The University of Chicago Law Review Online*, October 2020. (Not peer-reviewed)

2019 2. "Has the College Wage Premium Continued to Rise? Evidence from Multiple U.S. Surveys" (with Jared Ashworth), *Economics of Education Review*, 69 (1): 149–154.

2018 1. "Do High School Sports Build or Reveal Character? Bounding Causal Estimates of Sports Participation" (with Michael R Ransom), *Economics of Education Review*, 64 (1): 75–89.

Working Papers

2026 "Market Size Disparity Moderates Competitive Balance Interventions in US Sports Leagues" (with Kyle J. Davis, Christopher Black and Daniel J. Larson), Reject & Resubmit, *Journal of Sports Economics*

"Racial Preferences Under Admissions Constraints: Evidence from the U.S. Naval Academy" (with Peter Arcidiacono and Matthew Lilley), Revise & Resubmit, *Journal of Law and Economics*

2025 "Do Elite Universities Pick Sports to Pick Students? Athletic Admissions and SES Targeting" (with Ahmed El Fatmaoui), Revised & Resubmitted, *Review of Industrial Organization*

2024 "Are Vegetable Seed Oils Fueling the Obesity Epidemic?"

Works in Progress

"Beating the Heat: Temperature and Spatial Reallocation over the Long Run" (with Christos Makridis and Sumedha Ray)

"Elevation in Obesity: Uncovering the Geographical Aspects of Health" (with Pallab Ghosh)

"The Role of Supply and Demand Factors in Explaining the Migration of College Majors"

"Measuring Women's Wage Returns to Human Capital" (with Jared Ashworth)

Recent Policy Writings

2024 "Are Elite Colleges Circumventing the Supreme Court?" (with Peter Arcidiacono), *The Chronicle of Higher Education*, 3 Dec 2024

"Elite Universities and the Diversity Game" (with Peter Arcidiacono), *City Journal*, 28 Aug 2024

2021 "Amherst Is Dropping Legacy Admissions. Why Other Universities Aren't." (with Peter Arcidiacono and Josh Kinsler), *Barron's*, 2 Nov 2021

Recent Conference & Seminar Presentations

* indicates virtual presentation; † indicates discussant

2026–2027 San Diego State University; Trans-Pacific Labor Seminar (Honolulu, HI; scheduled)

2025–2026 Heritage Foundation Academic Prize Winner Colloquium (Washington, DC); Public Choice Society (San Antonio, TX)

2024–2025 University of Texas Rio Grande Valley*; University of Nebraska-Lincoln; Washington University in St. Louis; American Society of Health Economists Conference (Nashville, TN)

Teaching Experience

Oklahoma
- Econometrics III (PhD)
- *Structural Econ Guy* YouTube channel ($\approx 2,000$ subscribers; public outreach of Econometrics III course material)
- Econometric Analysis (undergraduate)
- Data Science for Economists (Master's)
- Economics of Education (undergraduate)
- Machine Learning with Causal Inference (Online Master's)

Duke
- Foundations of Matlab (PhD, field course)
- Causal Inference for Data Scientists (co-developer, with eBay DataLabs)
- Introduction to Julia (workshop)
- SSRI Education & Human Development seminar (co-instructor)

Fellowships & Awards

2025 Heritage Foundation Freedom and Opportunity Academic Prize

2022 OU Dodge Family College of Arts & Sciences Irene Rothbaum Outstanding Assistant Professor Award

2019 OU Presidential International Travel Fellowship

2018 OU Dodge Family College of Arts & Sciences Junior Faculty Summer Fellowship

Recent Media Appearances

2026 "'I'm not going to be alive tomorrow': Is gambling addiction Pa.'s next public health crisis?" by Oliver Morrison, *Patriot-News* (Harrisburg, PA), 15 Jun 2026

2024 "Meet the Class of 2028" by Sara Kumar, *Harvard Independent*, 19 Sep 2024

"How the Supreme Court Shaped the Class of 2028 at Harvard" by Elyse C. Goncalves and Matan H. Josephy, *Harvard Crimson*, 13 Sep 2024

2023 "US student-athletes in line for salaries" by Paul Basken, *Times Higher Education*, 6 Dec 2023

"UC axed 'VIP admissions' in the 90s. Today, Cal enrolls fewer ultra-rich students than its peers" by Ally Markovich, *Berkeleyside*, 10 Aug 2023

"The Supreme Court ended affirmative action for colleges. Are legacy admissions next to go?" by Jeff Cercone, *PolitiFact*, 7 Jul 2023

2022 "Fact-checking Rep. Jamaal Bowman on legacy admissions, affirmative action" by Elizabeth Egan and Marnique O. Panepento, *PolitiFact*, 7 Mar 2022

Podcast Appearances

2026	Newsweek's *The 1600* Podcast hosted by Carlo Versano, 18 May 2026
2025	Silk Road Revival Podcast hosted by Safar Choriev and Abror Abduazizov, 12 Sep 2025
	The Cause & Effect Podcast hosted by Vitor Melo, 28 May 2025
2024	The EconBuff Podcast hosted by Lee Stitzel, 15 Nov 2024

Student advising

(Initial placement in parentheses); * = business student; † = psychology student; § = education student; ¶ = political science student; ‡ = co-chair

PhD Thesis Chair	Sumedha Ray (expected 2028)
	Jhinuk Banerjee‡ (expected 2028)
	Bowei Dong‡ (2026)
	Ahmed El Fatmaoui‡ (2025; Wisconsin-La Crosse)
	Dayuan Xie‡ (2025)
	Gabe Lebovich‡ (2022)
PhD Thesis Committee	Austin Nettrouer¶ (expected 2029)
	Kyle Davis§ (expected 2028)
	Yeganeh Karbalaei (expected 2028)
	Andrew Zilles* (expected 2028)
	Chang Gao (expected 2027)
	Justin Canova* (expected 2027)
	Collin Devore (expected 2027)
	Mahla Shourian (expected 2027)
	Sara Asgari (expected 2027)
	Mengyang Davila* (2026; U of Oklahoma Lecturer)
	Hongyu (Jack) Wang* (2025; Illinois Urbana-Champaign Postdoc)
	Bill Townsend (2025; Cal Poly SLO Agribusiness)
	Adon Rosen† (2024; Vanderbilt Postdoc)
	Cheng Ma (2022; TransUnion)
	Brent Norwood (2020; Oklahoma State)
	Chen Xu (2020; St. Edward's)
MA Capstone	Sam Hunt (2026; Federal Trade Commission)
	Adam Matthies (2026; Oklahoma Sleep Institute)
	Will Nguyen (2024; MidFirst Bank)
	Bradley Rann (2024; OU Medical School)
	Beth Felkner (2024; Williams Energy)

MA	Caden Finley (2023; AXA XL)
Capstone	Emma Young (2023)
	Youngjun Yoon (2023; Paycom)
	Fuqing Yang (2022)
	Josie Pruett (2022; Love's)
	Carson Schlittler (2022; KPMG)
	Ethan Maddy (2022; Cambridge Health MA)
	Luke Denton (2022; LSE Development MA)
	Leah Pomerantz (2022; UW-Madison Econ PhD)
	Ningjing Gao (2021; OU Econ PhD)
	Abby Hoffman (2021; Kansas City Fed)
	Hunter McCans (2021; Oklahoma Policy Institute)
	Natalie Cook (2021; Hertog Foundation Fellowship)
	Orin Imtiaz (2021; Deloitte)
	Grant Naberhaus (2021; Ernst & Young)
	Katy Yut (2021; Bureau of Economic Geology)
	Emma Reinsch (2021; OU Econ PhD)
	Joe Ezzell (2020; Paycom)
	Sam Quick (2020; Ovintiv)
	Conrad Polkosnik (2020; Schlumberger)
	Binyue Ling (2020)
	Alex Hinshaw (2019; SMU Law)
	Jiongliang Tao (2019)
	Alexandra Penner (2018; MSCI)
	Joel McGuire (2018; Colorado St. Econ PhD)
BA Honors	Max Geiszler (2022; OU Philosophy PhD)
	Leah Pomerantz (2022; UW-Madison Econ PhD)
	Ethan Maddy (2022; Cambridge Health MA)
	Grant Naberhaus (2021; Ernst & Young)
	Logesh Balaguru (2021; OU Medical School)
	Austin Parker (2021; Carta)
	Liam Ferrer (2021; WashU Law)
	Ryan McAlister (2021; Booz Allen Hamilton)
	Logan Schoonover (2020; Goldman Sachs)
	Katie King (2020; Vanderbilt Nursing MA)
	Joey Herrera (2020; Texas Econ MA)
	Stephanie Jansson (2020; U of Iowa Biostatistics PhD)

	Alex Hinshaw (2019; SMU Law)
	Alexander Stubblefield (2019; Michigan St. Econ PhD)
	Parker Strubhar (2019; Georgetown Communications MA)
	Will Milam (2018; SMU Law)
H&ES	Ebenezer Olubayode (2025)
MA Thesis	Kyle Davis (2025; OU Adult and Higher Education PhD)
	Colton Steele (2024; LEARFIELD Amplify)
	Blake Buchman (2022; Simplebet)
	Megan Yarberry (2021; Jacksonville Jaguars and FanDuel)
	Joe Castiglione, Jr. (2021; Transform Enterprises)
McNair Scholarship	Joey Herrera (2020; Texas Econ MA)

SKILLS

Coding Expertise:	Matlab, Stata, R, Julia, LaTeX, Shell/Bash, SLURM, Git
Coding Experience:	SAS, Qualtrics, HTML, SQL, Python, Hadoop, Spark
Security Clearance:	Special Sworn Status (US Census Bureau; expired)
Certification:	Certificate in College Teaching (Duke University, 2015)
Languages:	English (native), Japanese (advanced), Korean (beginner), German (beginner)

Departmental, College, and University Service

2025–26	Chair, OU Econ dept faculty search committee
2024–25	Member, OU Econ dept faculty search committee
2024	Member, DFCAS Graduate Fellowship Award Committee
2024–26	Member, OU Econ dept Executive and Tenure & Promotion Committees (called "Committee A" at OU)
2024–	Director, OU Econ MA Programs
2022–23	Core Faculty, OU DFCAS Data Scholarship Program
2022–	Faculty Advisor, OU LDS Student Association
2021–22	Faculty Advisor, OU Sports Data Analytics Association
2022	Member, DFCAS Graduate Fellowship Award Committee
2021–25	Chair, OU Econ Applied Microeconomics Brown Bag Seminar Series
2021	Member, OU Econ Department Chong Liew Award Committee
2021	Member, OU Econ Department Strategic Plan Committee
2021	Member, OU Provost's Dissertation Prize Committee
2019–	Panelist, OU English Communication Capacity (ECC) test
2017–21	Member, OU College of Arts & Sciences Big Data and Stats Working Group
2016	Member, Duke SSRI Education & Human Development Scholars Recruiting Committee

Professional Service

Referee: (x 184)

AEJ: Applied Economics (3); *AEJ: Economic Policy* (4); *AEJ: Macroeconomics*; *American Economic Review* (4); *AER: Insights*; *American Educational Research J.* (2); *Annals of Economics and Statistics* (2); *Applied Economics Letters*; *Applied Economics Teaching Resources*; *B.E. J. of Economic Analysis & Policy*; *Bulletin of Economic Research* (2); *China Economic Review* (5); *Contemporary Economic Policy* (3); *Economic Development Quarterly* (4); *Econ. Dev. & Cultural Change* (2); *Economics of Education Review* (18); *Economic Inquiry* (5); *Economic Journal* (4); *Education Economics* (2); *Education Finance and Policy* (2); *Educational Researcher*; *Empirical Economics* (2); *European Economic Review* (6); *Frontiers in Nutrition*; *Frontiers in Sustainable Food Systems*; *Health Economics* (2); *Higher Education*; *Int'l Journal of STEM Education*; *Int'l Review of Economics Education*; *ILR Review* (2); *Journal of Applied Econometrics* (8); *Journal of Comparative Economics*; *Journal of Development Economics*; *J. of Econ. Behavior & Organization* (3); *Journal of Economic Psychology* (2); *J. of Economics, Race, and Policy*; (3) *J. of Family and Economic Issues* (2); *Journal of Housing Economics* (2); *Journal of Human Capital* (5); *Journal of Human Resources* (6); *Journal of Industrial Economics*; *Journal of Labor Economics* (7); *J. of Policy Analysis and Mgmt* (5); *Journal of Political Economy*; *JPE Microeconomics* (3); *Journal of Population Economics*; *Journal of Public Economics* (2); *Labour Economics* (6); *Labour* (2); *Nature Human Behavior*; *Oxford Economic Papers*; *Oxford Bulletin of Econ. and Stats.*; *Papers in Regional Science* (2); *Quantitative Economics* (5); *Regional Sci. and Urban Economics* (3); *Research in Higher Education* (2); *Research in Labor Economics*; *Review of Economics and Statistics* (5); *Review of Economic Studies*; *Review of Industrial Organization*; *Scandinavian Journal of Economics* (3); *Scottish Journal of Political Economy*; *Southern Economic Journal* (7); Swiss National Science Foundation; Russell Sage Foundation (2); Fordham Institute; Princeton University Press

2022 Organizing Committee, International Association for Applied Econometrics Conference